

Harira (Moroccan Tomato, Lentil & Beef Soup)

Harira is a tomato-based soup featured at the center of many Moroccan tables during the month of Ramadan. It's often enjoyed as part of iftar—the meal served to break the fast each evening—along with dates, milk, hard-boiled eggs, semolina pancakes and chebakia (sesame cookies). This version features chickpeas, lentils, beef and noodles in a fragrant tomato broth, but there are endless variations on the soup.

By **Salima Benkhalti** | Updated on October 2, 2025

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 20 mins

Total Time: 1 hr 10 mins

Servings: 8

Nutrition Profile:

Gut Healthy Mediterranean Diet Sesame-Free Diabetes-Friendly Nut-Free Dairy-Free Healthy Pregnancy Soy-Free High-Fiber High-Protein Egg-Free

Ingredients

- 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 pound beef stew meat, cut into bite-size pieces
- 1 medium onion, diced
- 2 stalks celery, chopped
- 3/4 cup minced fresh cilantro, divided, plus more for garnish
- 3/4 cup minced fresh parsley, divided
- 8 cups water
- 1 28-ounce can crushed tomatoes
- 1 cup dry brown *or* green lentils, rinsed
- 1 cup no-salt-added canned chickpeas, rinsed
- 1 tablespoon ground pepper
- 2 teaspoons ground ginger
- 1 1/2 teaspoons salt
- 1/2 teaspoon ground turmeric
- 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- 1 cup fideo noodles *or* broken vermicelli

Directions

Step 1

Heat oil in a large pot over medium heat. Add beef, onion, celery and ¼ cup each cilantro and parsley. Cook, stirring occasionally, until the beef is browned and the onion and celery are softened, about 10 minutes.

Step 2

Add water, tomatoes and their juice, lentils, chickpeas, pepper, ginger, salt, turmeric and cinnamon to the pot. Bring to a boil over high heat, then reduce heat to a simmer. Cook, covered and stirring once or twice, until the beef and lentils are tender, about 45 minutes.

Step 3

Stir the soup well; add noodles. Cook over medium-high heat, stirring occasionally, until the noodles are tender, 5 to 7 minutes. Stir in the remaining ½ cup each cilantro and parsley. Serve garnished with more cilantro, if desired.

EatingWell.com, March 2024

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1 2/3 cups** 329 calories; total fat 9g; saturated fat 2g; cholesterol 56mg; sodium 645mg; total carbohydrate 37g; dietary fiber 7g; total sugars 7g; added sugars 0g; protein 29g; vitamin c 20mg; calcium 91mg; iron 6mg; potassium 807mg

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